

AELITA

PRODUCTION

PRESS RELEASE

Stary Oskol, August 19, 2026

## AELITA PRODUCTION Brings Alexander Panov's Meditative Detective Piece "Porfiry" to the "Tochka Cuire" Festival

On October 24 at 19:00, CSI "Byl" (Stary Oskol, Zhukova microdistrict 38, Red Hall) hosts "Porfiry" as part of the "Tochka Cuire" contemporary art festival — a meditative detective piece inspired by Dostoevsky and Akutagawa, produced by AELITA PRODUCTION. Directed by and starring Alexander Panov. Running time — about an hour, 16+.

### ABOUT THE PRODUCTION

*The murder of an old pawnbroker. No clues. No known motive. The suspects have scattered through a bamboo grove among young Japanese cedars. Meditation. Ikigai. Bushido. Only this will help Porfiry solve the most sinister crime in Russian literature.*

"Porfiry" is a mash-up inspired by Dostoevsky's "Crime and Punishment" and the prose of Ryūnosuke Akutagawa: investigator Porfiry Petrovich conducts an inquiry in a space where Russian psychological drama meets Japanese contemplation. The solo production combines detective intrigue with audience interaction and a meditative rhythm.

### ABOUT THE DIRECTOR

Alexander Panov is the director and performer of "Porfiry", a resident artist of AELITA PRODUCTION.

### REVIEWS

*"The show 'Porfiry' was a wonderful intellectual game, full of memes, favourite Akutagawa quotes and elegant Japanese touches, brimming with irony and humour" — Pyotr Semak, actor, Maly Drama Theatre*

*"For an hour the audience enjoyed a triumph of postmodernism and irony, drawing on homemade haiku and quotes from Hayao Miyazaki's films" — Yulia Batalina, "Novy Kompanyon"*

*"Wittily quoting social-media memes and clearly relishing himself on stage, the actor switches between deep meditative states and interaction with the hall" — Mila Denyova, "Petersburg Theatre Journal"*

### ABOUT THE "TOCHKA CUIRE" FESTIVAL

"Tochka Cuire" is AELITA PRODUCTION's annual contemporary art festival at CSI "Byl", Stary Oskol. Its first edition runs October 22–25, 2026: fifteen productions over four days — from the flagship mystery play to physical theatre, performances and a promenade show — plus exhibitions, a business programme and a lecture series.

### ABOUT THE VENUE

CSI "Byl" is the first contemporary art centre in the Belgorod region, opened in 2023 in the restored building of the former "Byl" cinema (1982). Two auditoriums — Blue Hall (496 seats) and Red Hall (168 seats) — allow parallel performances.

## ABOUT THE COMPANY

AELITA PRODUCTION is a theatre production company founded in 2025 by Ekaterina Abdulova and Konstantin Moshnikov. In under a year of work — more than 10 projects delivered and a presence in 4 Russian cities. The company produces the creation, touring and distribution of productions at the intersection of contemporary theatre, choreography and visual art.

## TEAM

Director & performer — Alexander Panov

Second director — Svetlana Nikiforova

Set designer — Alexey Vasilyev

## DATE, TIME AND PLACE

October 24, 2026, 19:00

CSI “Byl”, Stary Oskol, Zhukova microdistrict 38, Red Hall

Running time — about an hour · 16+

**Tickets:** <https://cuire-fest.ru/tickets/>

## PRESS CONTACTS

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